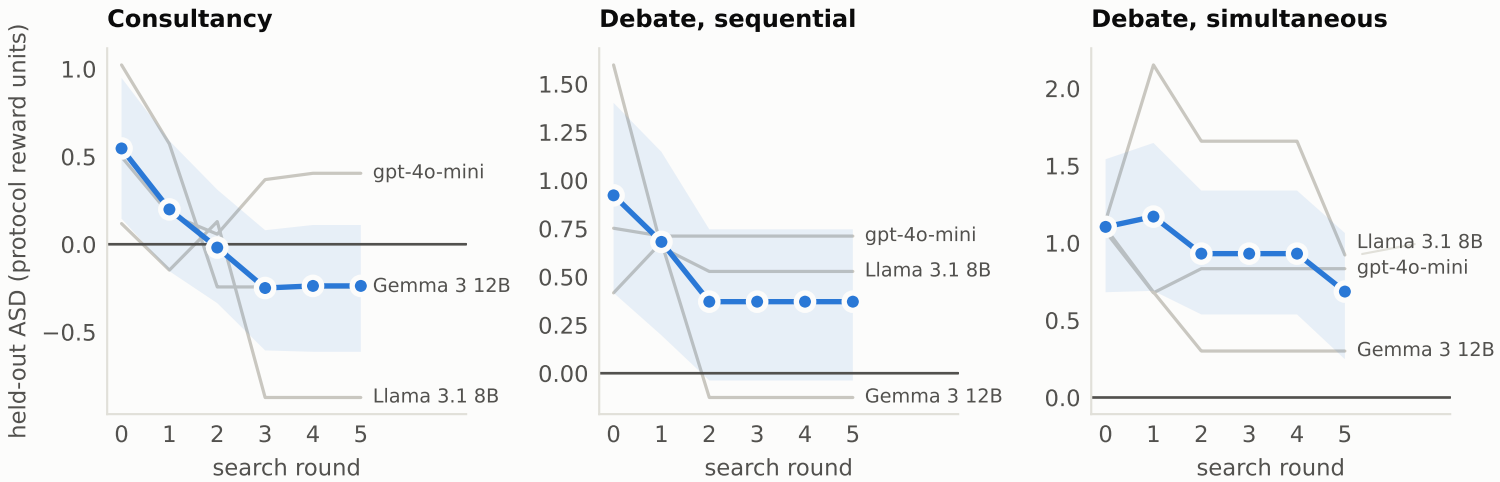
Prompt optimization: honest vs deceptive strategies found by an optimizer, scored on held-out items

Blue: 3 judges pooled, with 95% item-bootstrap band; gray: each judge. Round 0 is the unprompted agent on each side (the instructed sampler); each round keeps the best strategy so far on 36 training items; ASD on 80 held-out items.